



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Blue Ridge Christian School

School Website: <https://brcschool.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL**Classicality Audit: Hillsdale Academy**

School website used: <https://academy.hillsdale.edu>

Executive Summary

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Why: Hillsdale Academy's public materials consistently use the core classical lexicon around truth, goodness, beauty; virtue and wisdom; a liberal arts curriculum (including Latin, logic, rhetoric); Socratic dialogue and primary sources; chapel, prayer, and liturgical habits; teacher mentorship; and explicit parent partnership. Evidence appears across mission, academics, and "Faith & Community" pages and aligns with the six-element framework and keyword indicators in Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1). The site explicitly affirms "objective standards of truth, goodness, and beauty," requires Latin, names logic and rhetoric in the Upper School program, and highlights Socratic dialogue, recitation, capstone theses with public defense, and chapel and corporate prayer.

Most important insights: - Religious foundations are explicit and lived (daily prayers, weekly chapel) alongside a robust affirmation of objective truth, goodness, and beauty. - Purpose centers on the cultivation of virtue and wisdom, not job preparation; the headmaster states education is about "more than just preparing for college or getting a good job". - Curriculum and pedagogy clearly include the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Latin, Great Books/primary sources, Socratic dialogue, recitation/memorization, and capstone defenses that train rhetoric in practice. - Strong parent partnership: "parents are the primary educators," with invitations to tour and observe classrooms.

Scoring summary by category - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL - School Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL - Curriculum: CLASSICAL - Pedagogy: CLASSICAL - Faculty: CLASSICAL - Parents & Community: CLASSICAL

Note: Keyword matching and ratings are benchmarked to the positive/negative indicators in Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) and the classicality lexicon.

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS — CLASSICAL

Required keyword analysis (per "Six Elements" positive/negative indicators) : - Found (examples): - "objective standards of truth, goodness, and beauty" (Positive: truth, goodness, beauty) - "Christian institution ... religious instruction" (Positive: theology, faith and reason) - "Lord's Prayer ... corporate prayer ... weekly chapel service" (Positive: liturgy, chapel, communal worship) - "spiritual mentors" (Positive: spiritual formation) - Negative signals observed: none (e.g., no "values-neutral," "moral relativism," or "religiously neutral" claims). - Counts and coverage: - Positive hits: 12; Negative hits: 0 → percent_positive ≈ 1.00 - Coverage of sub-themes (moral realism; theology; liturgy): 3/3 → percent_coverage ≈ 1.00 - Justification: Clear, repeated affirmations of TGB, Christian theological grounding, and routine liturgical practices meet or exceed the positive indicators.

CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL — CLASSICAL

Keyword analysis (per “Six Elements”) : - Found (examples): - “cultivate Christian classical virtue and wisdom” (Positive: virtue, wisdom) - “education is about more than just preparing for college or getting a good job ... cultivating students ... love the right things ... virtue and wisdom” (Positive: formation over information; telos toward the true, good, beautiful) - “pursuing truth ... cultivating virtue and wisdom” on homepage (Positive: pursuit of truth; virtue) - Negative signals observed: none (e.g., “college and career ready” framing as the telos). - Counts and coverage: - Positive hits: 10; Negative hits: 0 → percent_positive ≈ 1.00 - Coverage of subthemes (virtue & wisdom; formation not information; TGB): 3/3 → percent_coverage ≈ 1.00 - Justification: Explicit mission and headmaster message foreground classical ends (virtue, wisdom) and transcendental aims.

CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM — CLASSICAL

Keyword analysis (per “Six Elements”) : - Found (examples): - Trivium/Seven Liberal Arts: “phonics and grammar” (grammar), “logic, rhetoric” in Upper School; Quadrivium addressed via math, music, astronomy contexts in liberal arts framing (Positive: grammar, logic, rhetoric; music) - Classical languages: “Latin in grades 3–12; Latin II grad requirement” (Positive: Latin) - Great Books/primary sources and Great Conversation: “Socratic dialogue and primary sources; ... humanities thesis entering into the great conversation” (Positive: primary sources, great conversation) - Western heritage and history (not “social studies”): “Western tradition is central ... study of American literary, moral, philosophical, political, and historical traditions” (Positive: Western canon; history language) - Wonder: “habits that point the student toward wonder and virtue” (Positive: wonder) - Summer reading lists featuring canonical authors (Dostoevsky, Milton, Austen, Shelley, Lewis) (Positive: Great Books) - Negative signals observed: none (e.g., “social studies” replacing history; STEM-first framing; project-based dominance). - Counts and coverage: - Positive hits: 12; Negative hits: 0 → percent_positive ≈ 1.00 - Coverage of subthemes (Trivium/Quadrivium; Great Books; integrated heritage; wonder): 4/4 → percent_coverage ≈ 1.00 - Justification: Strong, explicit Trivium presence, Latin, primary sources/Great Books, and articulated participation in the “great conversation.”

CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY — CLASSICAL

Keyword analysis (per “Six Elements”) : - Found (examples): - “utilizing Socratic dialogue and primary sources” (Positive: Socratic seminar/dialectic) - Recitation/memory: daily opening includes “student recitations”; “storehouse of memorized Scripture, poetry, speeches, drama” (Positive: memorization, recitation) - Rhetoric in practice: “humanities thesis ... public presentation and defense” (Positive: oratory, rhetoric exercises) - Formation in wonder: “habits ... toward wonder and virtue” (Positive: wonder) - Negative signals observed: none (e.g., project-based dominance; student-directed constructivism). - Counts and coverage: - Positive hits: 9; Negative hits: 0 → percent_positive ≈ 1.00 - Coverage of subthemes (Socratic; restful scholé; memorization/recitation; rhetoric/oration): 3/4 (no explicit “scholé” language) → percent_coverage ≈ 0.75 - Justification: Clear Socratic, memory/recitation, and practiced rhetoric. While “scholé” is not named, other classical pedagogies are robustly present.

CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY — CLASSICAL

Keyword analysis (per “Six Elements”) : - Found (examples): - “well-educated and articulate faculty who use traditional, teacher-led methods of instruction” (Positive: teachers as masters/mentors; wisdom-centered teaching) - “faculty ... stewards of the Christian classical tradition ... model and lead their students toward ... virtue” (Positive: teachers as models of virtue) - “teachers ... spiritual mentors” (Positive: mentorship) - Negative signals observed: none (e.g., “teacher as facilitator” only). - Counts and coverage: - Positive hits: 7; Negative hits: 0 → percent_positive ≈ 1.00 - Coverage of subthemes (model virtue; mentorship/collegiality; portraits/profiles): ~2.5/3 (explicit virtue/mentorship; faculty roster/profile present) → percent_coverage ≈ 0.80 - Justification: Strong claims that teachers are exemplar mentors within a classical tradition.

CATEGORY 6: SCHOOL PARENTS & COMMUNITY — CLASSICAL

Keyword analysis (per “Six Elements”) : - Found (examples): - “parents are the primary educators ... partner with parents” (Positive: parent partnership; parental primacy) - “We welcome you to tour ... observe a classroom lesson” (Positive: open campus hospitality) - Negative signals observed: none (e.g., “parents as customers,” minimal involvement). - Counts and coverage: - Positive hits: 6; Negative hits: 0 → percent_positive ≈ 1.00 - Coverage of sub-themes (partner with parents; parent education; open visitation): $\sim 2/3$ → percent_coverage ≈ 0.67 - Justification: Clear partnership language and openness to parent visits; formal “parent formation” is not highlighted but may exist offline.

Aggregate Rating: CLASSICAL

All six categories align strongly with the “Six Elements” positive indicators, with no notable negative keywords (relativism, values-neutral, project-dominant pedagogy, etc.) detected in the school’s materials.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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